Verb forms: the perfect tense

- This tense is used to describe
  - **What you did** *(I ate)*
  - **What you have done** *(I have eaten)*

- Only the context tells you whether *j'ai mangé* means *I ate* or *I have eaten*.

- Always use the perfect tense to describe **one-off EVENTS in the past**
- Most verbs use the present tense of AVOIR as the auxiliary verb. **To form regular past participles**, you need to change the ending of the infinitive as follows:
  - mangER – mang**É**
  - finIR - fin**I**
  - vendRE - vend**U**

  nous avons mangé *il a fini* *elles ont vendu*

- As usual, though a small group, **the most frequently needed past particples are irregular:**

avoir	**eu**	*voir*	**vu**
être	**été**	*recevoir*	**reçu**
faire	**fait**	*boire*	**bu**
dire	**dit**	*devoir*	**dû**
écrire	**écrit**	*savoir*	**su**
ouvrir	**ouvert**	*vivre*	**vécu**
conduire	**conduit**	*vouloir*	**voulu**
connaître	**connu**	*pouvoir*	**pu**
paraître	**paru**	*lire*	**lu**
croire	**cru**	*prendre*	**pris**
pleuvoir	**plu**	*mettre*	**mis**
tenir	**tenu**	*suivre*	**suivi**
venir	**venu**	*rire*	**ri**
courir	**couru**		

- The huge majority of verbs take **avoir** but a very common set of sixteen (and ALL reflexive verbs) , normally take **être**. These **"être verbs"** are:

  descendre, rester, arriver, partir, entrer, retourner, sortir
  venir, aller, naître
  monter, mourir, tomber, rentrer, devenir, revenir (16)

  Tip: Laid out as above you get the "registration number" of:

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- All of the above **non-reflexive être verbs need to make the past participle agree** with the subject in the perfect tense. "An "e" is added to make a participle feminine, and an "s" to make it plural.

- *Elle est alléE Elles sont rentréES.*

- Remember **ALL reflexive verbs use ÊTRE** as the auxiliary in addition to those 16 mentioned above.

  - *Nous nous sommes réveilléS Elles se sont vuES*

- **Try and remember this:**
  - 16 verbs use ÊTRE in the perfect tense
  - The past participle ALWAYS AGREES (see examples above)
  - All reflexive verbs also use ÊTRE in the perfect tense
  - The past participle of a reflexive verb **SOMETIMES** AGREES (see examples below and E Lent 1 for full details)

  - *elles se sont vuES elles se sont parlé* (no agreement)

Verb forms: the conditional tense

- The conditional tense is used to describe:
  - **What you would be doing** *(I would be eating)*
  - **What you would do** *(I would eat)*
  -
- **This tense is a mixture of the FUTURE and the IMPERFECT TENSE.** The stems are the same as for the future and the endings are the same as for the imperfect. Revise the **irregular future stems**.

Verb forms: the pluperfect and conditional perfect tense

- These tenses are made up of the imperfect or conditional auxiliary verb, and a past participle. They should be revised from E Summer 1.